

Version 1.0 Nodes SHALL ignore the contents of the Message Extensions payload, by skipping it, to access the [Message Payload](#).

4.4.2. Message Footer Field Descriptions

4.4.2.1. Message Integrity Check (variable length)

A sequence of bytes containing the message integrity check value (a.k.a. tag or MIC) for the message. The length and byte order of the field depend on the integrity check algorithm in use as specified in [Section 3.6, “Data Confidentiality and Integrity”](#).

The Message Integrity Check field SHALL be present for all messages except those of [Unsecured Session Type](#).

The MIC is calculated as described in [Section 4.8.2, “Security Processing of Outgoing Messages”](#).

4.4.3. Protocol Header Field Descriptions

4.4.3.1. Exchange Flags (8 bits)

An unsigned integer bit field containing the following subfields:

Table 13. Exchange Flags field definition

bit 7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0
-	-	-	V	SX	R	A	I

NOTE

All unused bits in the Exchange Flags field are reserved and SHALL be set to zero on transmission and SHALL be silently ignored on reception.

I Flag (1 bit, position 0)

The Initiator (I) flag is a single bit field which, when set, SHALL indicate that the message was sent by the initiator of the exchange.

A Flag (1 bit, position 1)

The Acknowledgement (A) flag is a single bit field which, when set, SHALL indicate that the message serves as an acknowledgement of a previous message received by the current message sender.

R Flag (1 bit, position 2)

The Reliability (R) flag is a single bit field which, when set, SHALL indicate that the message sender wishes to receive an acknowledgement for the message.

SX Flag (1 bit, position 3)

The Secured Extensions (SX) flag is a single bit field which, when set, SHALL indicate that the [Secured Extensions](#) portion of the message is present and has non-zero length. Version 1.0 Nodes SHALL set this flag to zero.